

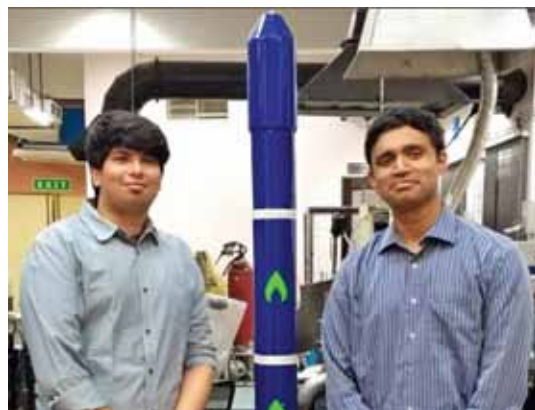
signed an agreement with India to aid in the creation of a semiconductor ecosystem in the country. As per the deal, IMEC will provide the technical support, specifically the technology to manufacture chips of sizes 28 nanometres and above. The user, in return, will pay a royalty for this technology. It must be noted that the cutting-edge tech from IMEC will be transferred to the company that sets up a semiconductor plant in India.

IAF inducts Tata Nexon EVs for green mobility

In accordance with the government's initiative on the introduction of green mobility, the Indian Air Force has inducted a fleet of Tata Nexon electric vehicles (EVs). Chief of the Air Staff, Air Chief Marshal V.R. Chaudhari, flagged off the first batch of 12 EVs at Air Force Headquarters, Vayu Bhawan along with other senior officers and staff. The first batch of these e-cars will be deployed in Delhi-NCR units for performance monitoring and analysis. IAF aims to achieve substantial reduction in carbon footprint with this initiative.

ISRO facilitates engine-testing by an Indian space startup

Rocket manufacturing startup Agnikul Cosmos has successfully test fired the single-piece, fully 3D printed, second-stage rocket engine powered by semi-cryogenic fuel at Vertical Test Facility of Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC), Thumba Equatorial Rocket Launching Station



Moim S.P.M. (left) and Srinath Ravichandran, co-founders, Agnikul Cosmos (Courtesy: Business Standard)

(TERLS), Thiruvananthapuram. The test was carried out as part of an MoU signed between ISRO and Agnikul Cosmos to provide an opportunity for Indian space startups to use the facilities of ISRO through IN-SPaCE. Agnikul Cosmos, a startup incubated at IIT Madras, raised \$11 million in Series A funding last year.

ABB opens its 1st smart instrumentation factory

ABB, a company that is known to push the boundaries of technology by connecting software to its electrification, robotics, automation, and motion portfolio, has now opened its first smart instrumentation factory in Bengaluru. In order to meet the growing demand for instrumentation devices and align itself with the local government's Make in India program, the company is in all support of the region's ambition of transforming into a global design and manufacturing hub.

NEOM invests in electric urban air mobility

NEOM has announced a whopping US\$175 million investment in Volocopter, a German air taxi manufacturing company. GLY Capital Management has also participated in the Series E funding round of Volocopter. The aircraft manufacturer aims to utilise

the funds for aircraft certification and launching of its first commercial routes in India. NEOM and Volocopter previously launched a joint venture way back in December 2021. India is looking forward to having eVTOL aircraft manufacturers set up bases in India.

Tata EV charging stations set up in Delhi Cantt

Sixteen EV charging stations were recently inaugurated at various locations in Delhi Cantonment. Through its 'Go-Green Initiative' the Indian Army has collaborated with Tata Power to set up these stations. The inauguration was carried out by Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth, GOC Delhi Area, in the presence of other army officials and senior executives from Tata Power and Tata Motors. The official statement specified that all 16 charging stations in Delhi Cantonment can be used both for personal and official EVs in Delhi Cantonment.

Exotel gets virtual network operator licence

Exotel is a full-stack customer engagement platform and business-focused virtual telecom operator that has now received the Unified Licence for Virtual Network Operator (UL VNO Access Service) from the Department of Telecommunications (DoT). The company will now extend its flexible, affordable, and fully compliant internet calling solutions to the entire country. They

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- Alif Semiconductor has collaborated with Telit to deliver developer kits that provide cloud-connected hardware and software reference designs for a wide variety of distributed and IoT edge applications.
- Bharat Electronics Ltd has signed a series of MoUs with defence-sector companies that include Yantra India Limited, US based Profense LLC, Spacefaring Technologies Pvt Ltd, SVC Tech Ventures LLP, and Hindustan Shipyard Limited.
- Excelpoint Systems and technology group Bkav Hardware Solution (BHS) recently announced a strategic tripartite partnership with Qualcomm to develop and commercialise an Artificial Intelligence of Things (AIoT) platform.
- Navitas Semiconductor and Avnet Silica have announced partnership to grow the market in Europe for Navitas' advanced performance and highly power-efficient GaNFast power ICs with GaNSense technology.
- TeamViewer has announced the availability of its enterprise augmented reality platform Frontline via Google Cloud Marketplace.
- CleanMax Enviro Energy Solutions provides power on per-kWh basis through long-term power purchase agreements, for which over 600 rooftop solar projects (with a total operating capacity of more than 350MW) have been installed across India, the United Arab Emirates, and Thailand.